

Austin Sustainable Interiors 2026

What the public record says about honest materials, reuse, and proof

The next useful step in sustainable design is simple to describe and harder to practice: keep material claims close to the project, the source, and the way a room will live over time.

INTRODUCTION

A note from Elena

When I walk into a room, I notice what already knows how to stay.

The oak casing that has held light for seventy years. The stone that feels cool before the house wakes up. The chair with a repair worth keeping. Sustainable interiors begin with that kind of attention.

For this brief, we studied five Austin-area design studios through their public websites, project pages, and social presence. We looked for residential scope, named materials, reuse, care, provenance, and clear investment information.

The field contains real work with reclaimed and retained materials. The distinction lies in how consistently a studio connects those choices to a named project and explains what they mean.

Elena Reyes

Founder, Casa Verde Studio

Reading the landscape: reuse is present. The clearer opening is repeatable proof around source, finish, care, and scope.

Method: public evidence reviewed through 16 September 2026. All five firms remain provisional for budget comparison because comparable total-project pricing was not disclosed. The sample does not establish market share or citywide demand.

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Austin-area firms reviewed as landscape examples

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Comparable public project price ranges confirmed

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Firms with reuse documented across more than one project

What honest materials means in 2026

A material earns trust when its story can be checked, its finish can be named, and its care can be understood.

01 Start with what stayed

Record the floor, casing, cabinetry, furniture, or masonry that remained. Retention can carry more meaning than replacement.

02 Name the source

Say whether a piece is reclaimed, salvaged, vintage, locally made, or newly produced. Name the supplier or craftsman when known.

03 Separate look from proof

Wood grain, stone, and greenery create atmosphere. A photograph alone cannot establish species, prior use, emissions, or environmental performance.

04 Explain finish and care

A low-VOC claim should point to a product or specification. A durable choice should come with repair and maintenance guidance.

05 Keep scope visible

Material decisions make more sense when the client can see whether the work covers one room, furnishing, a renovation, or new construction.

06 Respect the limits

A single project detail can be useful without becoming a claim about every project. Unknown information should stay unknown.

Casa Verde lens: honest materials have grain, weight, and a record. Their value comes from how they were chosen and how they will live, not from a surface that merely looks natural.

Evidence rule: material species, reclaimed status, emissions, certification, and provenance were counted only when a source named them. This framework does not turn visual style into environmental evidence.

Five studio snapshots

Urbane Design

POSITION Personal Austin interiors across remodeling, construction, and furniture.

MATERIALS Reclaimed doors at Misty Hill. White oak, stone, and tile at Big View.

PUBLIC GAP Recurrence and newer project documentation remain hard to assess.

Stelly Selway

POSITION Austin and London interiors shaped by durable materials, vintage pieces, and makers.

MATERIALS Oak recurs. Reclaimed pine, soapstone, vintage pieces, and dead-stock canvas have named examples.

PUBLIC GAP Previous use, quantities, finish records, and care vary by project.

Urbanspace Design Studio

POSITION Residential and commercial interiors shaped around how people use a space.

MATERIALS East Residence names a reclaimed-wood handle, Taj Mahal stone, and panels matched to the existing kitchen.

PUBLIC GAP Recurring practice remains unknown beyond one detailed case.

J.Fisher Interiors

POSITION Personal homes shaped by craft, art, and close designer involvement.

MATERIALS White oak and soapstone recur in two cases. Existing pieces were reused at Judges Hill.

PUBLIC GAP Broad low-VOC claims lack named product or finish records.

Studio Ferme

POSITION Residential interiors guided by material life cycles, climate resilience, and daily comfort.

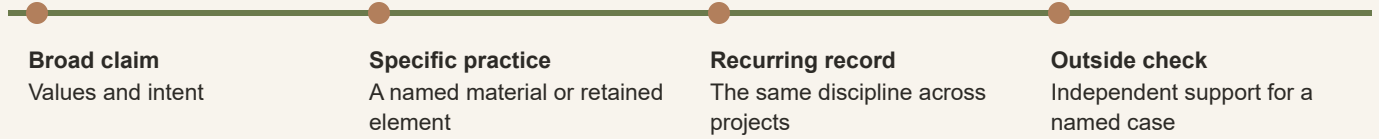
PUBLIC GAP A sabbatical has no public return date. Comparable price and current intake remain unknown.

MATERIALS Original shiplap reused at the 7th Street Cottage. AIA corroborates the Theresa project and interior-design credit.

These are public evidence snapshots, not ratings. Sources: Urbane, Stelly Selway, Urbanspace, J.Fisher, Studio Ferme, and the AIA Theresa record. Accessed 16 September 2026.

Where the market is heading

The public record points toward a quieter standard: fewer broad promises and more project-linked explanation.



Material names will need context

Oak, limestone, and linen say little on their own. Prior use, source, finish, repair, and care make the choice legible.

Retention will become easier to see

Clients can understand reuse when case studies name what remained and why. A room photograph rarely answers that question.

Scope will sit beside sustainability

A project record should show where design responsibility begins and ends. That clarity helps clients compare work without guessing from home size or neighborhood.

Investment language will carry more weight

None of the five firms disclosed a comparable total-project range. Clear scope examples could help homeowners understand fit before an inquiry.

What remains uncertain: five selected firms cannot prove a citywide shift or unmet demand. This outlook is a working interpretation of the reviewed public evidence.

Research base: five Austin-area firms, public websites and accessible social content, cutoff 16 September 2026. Pricing, hidden project records, and private client experience remain outside the evidence.

Our place in this picture

Casa Verde begins with reclaimed wood, native plants, low-VOC finishes, and locally sourced furniture. The standard we are setting is a public record that stays close to each project.

That means naming what we kept, where additions came from, how a finish was chosen, and what care the material needs. It also means staying honest when a detail is unknown.

The room remembers. Our case studies should remember with it.

The record we want every project to carry

Original elements retained. Material source and supplier. Finish specification. Repair and care guidance. Clear design and investment scope.

Five questions for any design conversation

- ☐ What can remain, and what condition is it in?
- ☐ Which additions have a source we can trace?
- ☐ What finish touches the air and the hand?
- ☐ How will each material age, clean, and repair?
- ☐ What does the stated project scope include?

Design that breathes.

Casa Verde Studio | East 6th Street, Austin

Casa Verde statements reflect the studio's brand intent. They are not third-party verification of project outcomes. Research sources and limits appear throughout this brief.